

WELL REGULATED MONOPOLY

A house-rule variant that stays a genuine contest - and finishes inside two hours.

Standard Monopoly is often decided long before it ends: one player pulls ahead and everyone else plays on with no real hope. These rules add a wealth tax on whoever is in the lead, shared out among the other players, so the game stays close to the very last round while still rewarding sharp play. Everything not listed below is played as normal Monopoly.

What changes

Starting cash. Each player starts with £1,000 - the standard opening deal, but with one £500 note instead of two:

1 x £500 2 x £100 2 x £50 6 x £20 5 x £10 5 x £5 5 x £1 = £1,000

Passing GO. Collect £400 instead of £200 each time you pass GO.

THE WEALTH TAX (the heart of the game)

At the end of every round (once all players have taken a turn), the player with the highest net worth who owns at least one property pays a wealth tax, split equally among all the other players (round to the nearest £1). The money stays in the game - it is never paid to the bank. Net worth = cash + printed price of owned property + cost of houses and hotels.

Players	Wealth tax at the end of each round
2 to 4 players	10% of the leader's net worth
5 to 6 players	15% of the leader's net worth

Winning

Play until 2 hours have passed or 30 rounds have been completed, whichever comes first. The player with the highest net worth then wins (cash + property + houses). If a player goes bankrupt earlier they are out as usual; and if only one player is left, they win at once.

Why it works, and how to win

Because the leader is taxed every round, no one can coast on an early lead - the pack is pulled back together, so the winner is rarely settled until the closing turns. To pull ahead you must keep playing actively: buy, build, and above all trade. A property you cannot complete into a set is still worth cash to a rival who can - so make the deal.

Worked example (4 players). At the end of a round the leader is worth £2,000. They pay 10% = £200, and each of the other three players receives about £67.